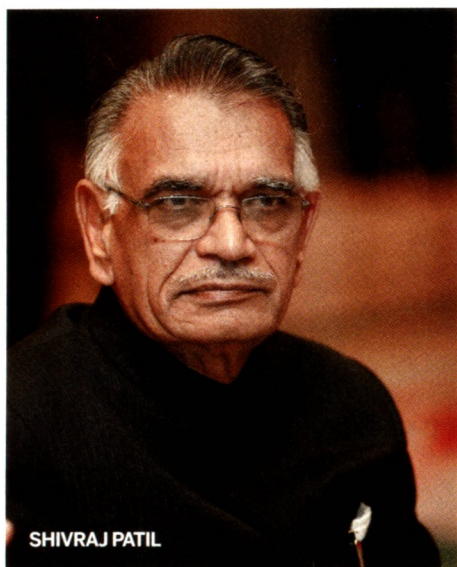


CHANDIGARH | Posts Script



SHIVRAJ PATIL

YASBANT NEGI/www.indiatodayimages.com

Speculation on whether the Punjab governor would give up charge of the Chandigarh administration were laid to rest when former home minister Shivraj Patil, who replaced General (retd.) S.F. Rodrigues, was named as the head of both. This is a setback for Union Minister and Chandigarh MP Pawan Bansal who has been seeking a separation of the two posts. Before terrorism hit Punjab in the 1980s, Chandigarh was administered by a bureaucrat of the Union territory cadre designated as chief commissioner. In the time of terror, the Punjab governor, also the administrator of Chandigarh, began to oversee police coordination. Bansal wanted the Centre to adopt the original system. But Punjab Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal had been against its revival as it could weaken Punjab's claim over Chandigarh.

by Arvind Chhabra

CALLS TO AN OFFICIAL HELPLINE FOR TROUBLED MINDS HAVE DOUBLED IN MUMBAI AND NOW ARE AT NEARLY 100 EVERY DAY.

MUMBAI | Saviours on Call

The recent spate of suicides in the city are the tip of a terrifying Mumbai iceberg. The number of calls to the helpline launched by the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation, along with the Cyrus and Priya Vandrevalla Foundation, have more than doubled from 40 a day to almost 100. Working round the clock, the Powai-based helpline has also received calls from cities like Hardwar, Surat and even from Bihar. "Those ideating on suicide feel the need to vent out just before taking the drastic step. At that point, they can be saved if heard out," says Dr Arun John, head of the foundation, stressing on the need for effective communication.

by Harsha Bhat

HYDERABAD | Serial Changer

Bangi Ananthaiah is master of disguise when it comes to lodging political protests. The former mayor of Kurnool and ex-TDP MLA dressed up as a woman carrying groceries on his head to highlight the impact of inflation on commoners. In the past, he has styled himself as a fakir with a begging bowl to protest against poor allocation of resources to Andhra Pradesh in the Union budget. On other occasions, he demonstrated atop buffaloes and donkeys to draw attention to the problems of the people. "Conventional forms of protest, including satyagraha or padayatra, do not work in making everyone realise how ordinary people are suffering," says Ananthaiah. Are K. Chandrasekhar Rao and the Telangana protagonists listening?

by Amarnath K. Menon



ANANTHAIAH PROTESTS RISING PRICES

MUMBAI | Berry Good

Very soon, you'll know whether the Mahabaleshwar strawberries you are popping are the real deal or not. More than 1,350 farmers from the Maharashtra hill station have applied for Geogra-



phical Indication (GI), which means that each strawberry box will carry a hologram proving the fruit's authenticity. The Shree-ram Fruit Processing Cooperative Society, Mahabaleshwar, is expecting to hear from the Government's GI Registry in the next three months. The special status will raise the fruit's prices by 10 per cent.

by Nishika Patel